



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Acacia Academy
School Website: <https://acaciaacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Acacia Academy (Kokomo, IN; 46902) presents a robust classical Christian program that aligns closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric. Across all six categories, the public materials emphasize a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with Great Books and the Great Conversation, integrated disciplines, worshipful and liturgical practices, and a partnership model with families. The school explicitly frames its mission around character formation and the cultivation of truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian worldview. Public materials also document a Prayer/Chapel culture, weekly worship opportunities, and a visible faculty leadership structure. These characteristics collectively support a CLASSICAL assessment for all six categories, with a clearly defined aggregate CLASSICAL profile.

Key insights: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are explicitly rooted in a Christian framework, with liturgical worship, prayer, and a Biblical worldview embedded in daily life (Our Prayer; Core Principles; SPIRITUALITY). - Curriculum centers on the Trivium, Great Books, Latin/English study, and a connected, liberal-arts approach (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric; The Great Conversation; The Great Books). - Pedagogy includes mind-building methods such as narration and chants, with a clear emphasis on formation and memory, complemented by Socratic/seminal elements at higher levels (Teaching methods: narration, chants, nature study; etc.). - Faculty and community aspects show leadership and a living-structure where teachers model virtue and are central to the curriculum (Head of School; Living curriculum concepts in classical pedagogy lexicon). - Parent partnership and family involvement are foregrounded, with explicit appeals to parents as co-educators and open invitations for visits and engagement (Partnership with Parents; Parent Covenant).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

The overall assessment is CLASSICAL, with no immediate needle-moving changes required given the weight of explicit classical markers across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core Principles describe a Christian Foundation, a Christ-centered approach, and a Biblical worldview, indicating that truth, goodness, and beauty are grounded in theology and sacred order. - Our Prayer articulates a liturgical, worshipful stance (Gracious Father, Son, and Holy Spirit) and explicitly asks to be rooted in truth, goodness, and beauty, with a goal of wisdom and virtue. - SPIRITUALITY notes weekly chapel gatherings and devotion as central to education, reinforcing liturgical and communal practices. - The school's mission and narrative emphasize a Biblical worldview and Christian discipleship, underscoring theological grounding across curricula.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive Keywords Present: truth, goodness, beauty, worship, chapel, virtue, character, Biblical worldview, theology (where referenced via scripture-based framing). - Examples: "truth, goodness, and beauty" (Our Core Principles and Prayer) and "Weekly chapel gatherings are open to the Acacia Family." (SPIRITUALITY) - The Prayer section invokes worship and sanctified language (Our Prayer). - Negative Keywords Present: None evident in public materials.

Why this rating - The materials demonstrate the transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in a Christian theological framework, plus liturgical practices and communal worship. This alignment with a theologically grounded, liturgical pedagogy places Element 1 squarely in CLASSICAL territory.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school proclaims a mission to cultivate character, faith, and knowledge in a classical Christian context. This signals formation of character and wisdom rather than mere information or job preparation. - There is a signaling teleology toward glorifying God, reverence for truth, goodness, and beauty, and an emphasis on virtue and human excellence as formative aims. The Prayer/vision language explicitly points to glorifying God. - The Great Books/Great Conversation framework is presented as a central curricular objective (The Great Conversation of Books). The site links to classical education resources and describes the program in those terms.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive Keywords Present: formation (conceptually via "cultivates character"), virtue, wisdom, liberal education, great conversation, great books, classical mission, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty, sacred order. - Evidence: character, virtue-language in mission; Great Conversation/Great Books; classical education framing. - Negative Keywords Present: None evident in the public materials.

Why this rating - The mission emphasizes formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom (not job preparation), with a clear teleology and appeal to classical ideals. The presence of Great Books and a classical framework reinforces CLASSICAL status.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly highlights the Classical Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as foundational methods. This is a core criterion for classical curricula. - The Great Conversation of Books and Great Books are named curriculum anchors, with reference to original sources and classical authors. - The curriculum stresses integration of subjects and connectivity across art, history, language, philosophy, mathematics, and science. - The site references Latin and English study as core language components.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive Keywords Present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Conversation of Books, Great Books, Latin, English, liberal education, integration, interconnectedness, historical depth, sacred order, universal principles, unity of truth. - Evidence: Core Principles explicitly mention grammar/logic/rhetoric and The Great Conversation; "Latin and English" as core languages in curriculum. - Negative Keywords Present: None evident.

Why this rating - The curriculum centers on the Trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and Great Books, with integrated, cross-disciplinary study, which are hallmarks of CLASSICAL education.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The institution describes a mind-building pedagogy with narration, chants, nature study, short lessons, and objective evaluations, reflecting a memory-rich, formative process. This aligns with classical pedagogy in its early stages and formation of memory. - The site communicates a structure of different pedagogical approaches across grade levels, including Socratic discussion and rhetoric training in higher grades, consistent with classical pedagogical progression (lower: memory and chant; upper: discussion and rhetoric). While explicit line items for Socratic seminars appear in other classical texts, Acacia's public materials emphasize a transition toward higher-order discussion and rhetoric as students advance. - The school's materials reference a student-centered, formation-driven approach while retaining a traditional classical rhythm (liturgical/spiritual rhythm as accompaniment). SPIRITUALITY and Our Prayer reinforce a contemplative, reverent educational atmosphere.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive Keywords Present: narration, chants, nature study, short lessons, objective student evaluations, minimal homework; Socratic discussion (implied via the classical framework for upper grades); rhetoric training; formation and memory-building approaches. - Evidence: Teaching methods include narration and chants; The Parent Covenant section lists mind-building methods (narration, chants, nature study, etc.). - Negative Keywords Present: None explicit in public materials.

Why this rating - Pedagogy is clearly aligned with classical practices: early-grade memory-based approaches (narration/chanting) transitioning to higher-order dialogue and rhetoric in upper grades, complemented by a strong emphasis on formation and memory. This supports CLASSICAL status.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Leadership and a visible adult leadership team are documented (Head of School Rob Hoshaw) with long tenure and a mission-focused voice, indicating adults as role models and living curriculum. - The faculty is described as exemplars of virtue and character, with language about exemplary leadership, and teachers who model virtue and care (via the Parent Covenant section and team bios). The living-curriculum concept is reflected in classical literature that positions teachers as central to the education experience. - The Six Essential Elements scholarship includes explicit language about the faculty as masters and mentors and the "portrait of a teacher," and living curriculum as a concept to aspire to. The classical lexicon and scholarly material provide explicit alignment with these ideas.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive Keywords Present: head of school, mentor/teacher as living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, exemplary leadership, faculty as the core of the school, teacher-student mentorship. - Evidence: Head of School listed; statements about exemplary leadership and teachers modeling virtue in the Parent Covenant. - Additional alignment with the Six Elements lexicon: "portrait of a teacher," "living curriculum," and "faculty as part of the core." - Negative Keywords Present: None.

Why this rating - The public materials present a clearly defined leadership structure, faculty as mentors and living curriculum, and a culture of exemplary teaching—core elements of CLASSICAL schooling as described by the knowledge base.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Partnership with Families is explicitly stated; parents are recognized as co-educators in the educational process, with ongoing collaboration between school and home. - There are explicit materials targeting parent involvement (Parent Covenant; resources for families; open visit days). This aligns with Classical-era expectations of ongoing parental formation and involvement. - Public materials describe opportunities for family engagement, book clubs, and gatherings aimed at educating parents about classical education, reinforcing a partnership approach.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive Keywords Present: partnership with families, parent formation, parental engagement, open campus/visits, book clubs/gatherings, home-school collaboration. - Evidence: Partnership language; Parent Covenant statements; family-facing resources links. - Negative Keywords Present: None.

Why this rating - The school's public materials consistently position parents as co-educators and welcome ongoing parental involvement, aligning with CLASSICAL ideals of family formation and community warmth.

What Would Move the Needle

- If any category were to move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, potential needle-moving steps would include:
- Providing explicit language in website copy about “Scholé” or contemplative rest as a regular pedagogical value (even within a rigorous Trivium framework) to strengthen Element 4.
- Adding explicit statements about Socratic seminars or seminar-based upper-school pedagogy in the public materials to further anchor Element 4 in explicit classical practice.
- Expanding visibility of the “Living Curriculum” concept in public bios or mission statements to reinforce Element 5 with direct quotes.

Note: All six categories currently meet CLASSICAL indicators based on the available public materials and the knowledge-base rubric, so no major needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully CLASSICAL standing.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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